

Deep Research Request Template

Get serious research out of Claude — not generic summaries

Claude's Research feature can investigate hundreds of sources and compile a cited report in minutes. But the quality of the output depends entirely on the quality of the request. A vague question gets a vague answer. This template helps you frame research requests that produce actionable, trustworthy results.

The Research Request Template

Fill in each section, then combine them into a single prompt. Every field matters — the more specific you are, the more useful the output.

THE QUESTION

What specifically do you want to know?

Be precise. "What are the cybersecurity risks of remote work?" is okay. "What are the top 5 cybersecurity incidents caused by remote work policies at mid-market companies in 2024-2025, and what policy changes prevented recurrence?" is better.

YOUR CONTEXT

Who are you and why does this matter to you?

e.g., I'm a VP of Operations at a 200-person manufacturing company considering a major ERP migration. I need to brief our board on risks and timeline.

YOUR CONSTRAINTS

What limits or requirements shape this research?

e.g., Budget under \$500K, must integrate with existing SAP modules, needs to be implementable within 12 months, regulated industry (FDA).

WHAT YOU'LL DO WITH IT**How will you use this research?**

e.g., Present recommendations to the board next Thursday, write an RFP, make a go/no-go decision, brief my team, write a policy document.

FORMAT YOU WANT**How should the output be structured?**

e.g., Executive summary + detailed findings + recommendation with pros/cons + sources. Or: comparison table of 4 vendors + risk assessment + implementation timeline.

Putting It Together

Here's the template with all five pieces combined into a single prompt:

I want you to research [your question].

My situation: [your context].

Constraints: [your constraints].

I plan to use this to [what you'll do with it].

Please deliver: [format you want].

Do not fabricate information. Do not invent statistics, names, dates, or citations. If you don't have reliable information on something, say so. Flag anything you're uncertain about.

After You Get the Report

Run these five checks before you use anything:

1	Is it tailored or generic? If it reads like it could apply to anyone, push back: "This is too generic. Tailor it to my specific situation: [restate context]."
2	Are the citations real? Click 3-5 links. If they're dead or don't say what Claude claims, flag it and ask for corrections.
3	What surprised you? The most valuable part of research is what you didn't think to ask about. If nothing surprises you, the research was too shallow.
4	What's missing? Ask directly: "What important aspects of this topic did you not cover? What would a skeptic say about these findings?"
5	What do you do first? If the report doesn't make your next action clear, ask: "Based on this research, what are my three most important next steps?"

Follow-Up Prompts That Make Research Better

Go deeper on one section

The section on [topic] is the most relevant to my decision. Expand it with more detail, more examples, and more specific data.

Challenge the findings

Play devil's advocate on your own recommendations. What are the strongest arguments against each one?

Make it actionable

Turn the findings into a 90-day action plan with specific milestones, owners, and decision points.

Simplify for a different audience

Rewrite the executive summary for [audience] who [what they know/don't know]. Keep it under [length].

This resource is a companion to Chapter 4 of Creating with Claude: A Practical Guide for Everyone. In the book, you run a real investigation on a question that matters to your work and learn to evaluate what comes back. Get the book at marquepublishing.com.